



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Aletheia Christian School of Peoria
School Website: <https://peoriaclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Aletheia Christian School Of Peoria IL 61604 presents a coherent classical-Christian model rooted in a Christ-centered worldview, explicit Trivium framing, and active parental partnership. Public materials demonstrate a deliberate integration of classical aims (truth, goodness, beauty) with a Christian worldview, a defined grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum, and a pedagogy that alternates contemplative, memory-based lower-division practice with Socratic, rhetoric-focused work in the upper grades. The school frames its mission around formation of character and wisdom in light of a biblical worldview, rather than mere information transfer or career preparation. Relative to the classical rubric, the school displays strong CLASSICAL alignment in most categories, with Element 5 (Faculty) showing only partial alignment and thus a potential area for further strengthening. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key evidence includes: explicit articulation of a Christian, Word-centered education with a biblical worldview (Christ-centered / Word-centered) and a Statement of Faith alignment (Protestant-evangelical) in Academics and Christ-centered sections; a clear articulation of the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and Great Books/Great Conversation framing in K–8 materials; a pedagogy that blends memorization, singing, and contemplation (scholé) in lower grades with Socratic discussion and rhetoric in upper grades; and ongoing parental partnership as core to the mission. The school also features a living staff presence across multiple levels, illustrating a culture of mentorship and teacher leadership, though the explicit language of “living curriculum” is not as overt as in some classical schools. Citations from the school's site and the classical lexicon support these observations.

Evidence highlights: - Christ-centered, Word-centered education and a biblical worldview (Academics, Christ-centered Education)

- Trivium framework with Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric stages (K–8) and a focus on Great Books/Great Conversation lineage (K-8) - Lower-division memory, chant, song with a contemplative dimension; upper-division Socratic seminars and rhetoric experience (pedagogy) - Parental partnership and invitation to participate (About Us / Admissions)

- Faculty pages and staff involvement illustrating mentorship and leadership (staff profiles)

Overall, Aletheia aligns strongly with classical education principles and earns CLASSICAL in aggregate, with Element 5 (Faculty) representing the primary area for potential enhancement to reach full CLASSICAL status across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school declares a Christ-centered, Word-centered approach in academics, explicitly tying truth to biblical revelation and God's world view (Academics / Christ-centered Education)

- The doctrinal stance anchors in a Protestant-evangelical Statement of Faith; education is pursued through a Christian lens rather than secular relativism (Academics) - The Great Books/Great Conversation lineage is implied through classical-textual framing and the Dorothy Sayers lineage in the school's history (About Us / History)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, God, Word of God, Christ-centered, biblical values, theology, gospel-driven, Word-centered, true/True, beautiful/beauty. - Negative keywords: none of the listed negative signals clearly appear in the public materials (e.g., relativism, secular humanism, values clarification). The materials emphasize a theological foundation rather than secular alignment.

Why this rating - The materials foreground transcendental moral realism through a Christian worldview and a theology-informed curriculum, with explicit references to truth and the Word of God as real and knowable and to virtue through a gospel-centered formation. The absence of explicit secular relativism or neutral moral language further supports CLASSICAL in this dimension. The cited sources demonstrate a coherent religious-metaphysical foundation anchored in Christian doctrine and liturgical-inflected community life.

Citations: Christ-centered framework and truth-centered language (Academics) ; Christ-centered, Word-centered worldview (Christ-centered Education) ; Statement of Faith and Protestant-evangelical alignment (Academics)

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly targets formation of virtue, wisdom, and a human-flourishing telos; “the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” appears as the central aim, not simply job prep (About Us / History; Home page) - The Great Conversation and classical formation framing appear in the school’s rationale and “intentional outliers” narrative, indicating a formation orientation beyond information accumulation (Intentional Outliers; History) - The Trivium and canonical education are presented as the core architecture shaping formation (K-8)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, great conversation, classical heritage, scholé (contemplation), lifelong learning. - Negative keywords: none clearly present (no explicit “workforce preparation” emphasis; the site emphasizes formation and virtue over job-readiness).

Why this rating - The school’s stated aims align with formation-oriented, virtue-focused education consistent with classical philosophy rather than merely information delivery or career prep. The language around “true/good/beautiful,” formation, and a long-range telos supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Formation and virtue language (About Us) ; True/Good/Beautiful articulation (About Us / Christ-centered page) ; Great Conversation / classical framing (Intentional Outliers) ; Trivium framing (K-8)

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is formalized as Grammar Stage, Logic Stage, and Rhetoric Stage; the curriculum is presented as mapping to child development (K-8) - The curriculum emphasizes the liberal-arts trajectory, with engagement in Western classical works and great books; memory-based learning and memorization are noted in the Grammar Stage (K-6) and music/song reinforcement (lower grades) - There is explicit reference to “great books,” “great conversation,” and classical heritage, including engagement with Western civilization and primary sources in the classical frame (About Us; Academics) - Lower and upper grade pedagogy includes chant, memory, recitation, Socratic-style discussion, and rhetoric-focused activities (K-8; Academics)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, great conversation, history (Western civilization), liberal arts, memorization, chant, memory-work, recitation, lectures, rhetoric/speeches. - Negative keywords: avoidance of “social studies” framing in favor of history; avoidance of pure project-based learning emphasis in the public materials.

Why this rating - The evidence demonstrates a robust classical curriculum architecture centered on the Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation lineage, and a historic Western-civilization orientation, consistent with CLASSICAL criteria.

Citations: Trivium framing and Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric (K-8) ; Great Books/Great Conversation framing (About Us) ; Classical memory/chant in lower grades (K-8) ; Little Classics Preschool mentions classic

literature and Bible stories (Little Classics Preschool)

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy blends contemplative, restful, memory-based learning (scholé) in early grades with Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and rhetoric training in upper grades (K-8) - Lower-division activities emphasize singing, chanting, and memory work as a vehicle for memory and delight in learning (Grammar Stage) - Upper-division pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debate, and opportunities for students to produce speeches and exercise rhetoric (K-8) - The school emphasizes a balance of restful, contemplative learning alongside rigorous, argument-based discourse (K-8; Academics)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, wonder, memory-work, recitation, chanting, singing, Socratic seminar, debate, rhetoric, oratory, speeches. - Negative keywords: minimal presence of purely “experiential learning” or constructivist excess; the public materials frame pedagogy around classical forms rather than project-based-only approaches.

Why this rating - The school’s pedagogy aligns with classical teaching methods that combine contemplative, mnemonic, and liturgical forms with rigorous, dialectic, and rhetorical activities. The explicit structure of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric progression and the presence of Socratic-style and rhetoric-driven activities favor CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium-based pedagogy (K-8) ; Memory/chant in lower grades (Grammar Stage) ; Socratic/dialectic/seminar/rhetoric in upper grades (K-8)

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are presented as mentors and leaders with roles in forming character and mind, with several staff pages highlighting teachers who articulate classical-Christian foundations (e.g., Kristi Schache, Gretchen Mahan; Head of School; staff profiles) - The public materials describe teachers as part of the school’s living culture, with “Head of School,” “Office Manager,” and other staff serving as visible leaders and contributors to “cultivating character” and “training minds” (staff pages and testimonials) - Phrases such as “Aletheia means ‘truth’... truth itself,” “teachers provide classical and Christian foundations for a lifetime love of learning,” and similar language indicate teachers function as a core component of the school’s mission/theme (Staff pages; Testimonials)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, teachers as guides/masters, portrait of a teacher, character formation, classical and Christian foundations. - Negative signals: The explicit phrase “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” are not ubiquitous across all pages; the public materials do not consistently frame a formal “faculty as living curriculum” doctrine in a single declarative statement, though the sentiment exists in multiple teacher descriptions and testimonials. There is not a strong, explicit, consistently stated “Living Curriculum” policy across all pages, which is a hallmark of some classical schools.

Why this rating - The presence of dedicated, credentialed staff and explicit statements about teachers who model virtue and guide student formation supports CLASSICAL, but the lack of a consistently explicit articulation of a formal “living curriculum” philosophy across all materials yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for this category. The evidence shows teacher leadership and mentorship, but the explicit, codified living-curriculum framing is less overt than in some classical institutions.

Citations: Teacher descriptions and mentorship language (Kristi Schache; Gretchen Mahan) ; Staff overview and leadership roles (Head of School; Office Manager) ; Classroom/teacher-focused testimonials (Intentionally quoted statements)

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents as a primary influence, with parents described as co-teachers and active participants in the child’s education (About Us; Academics) - There is explicit

mention of parent formation, reading groups, book studies, and gatherings as a means to educate parents in classical approaches (About Us; Admissions; academic pages) - The school invites parental involvement and visits, highlighting an open, participatory school culture (About Us / Admissions)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, book clubs, open-campus/visit opportunities. - Negative signals: none evident; materials emphasize parent engagement rather than consumerized or purely transactional relationships.

Why this rating - The school consistently presents a model in which parents are central to the educational process, aligning well with classical norms around parent partnership and co-formation. The presence of parent-centric programs, book clubs, and gatherings strengthens the CLASSICAL standing in this category.

Citations: Partnership with parents and parental primacy (About Us) ; Parent formation and involvement language (About Us / Admissions) ; Open-visit/participation language (Admissions)

What Would Move the Needle

- If Element 5 (Faculty) remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, consider clearly codifying and publishing a formal "Living Curriculum" statement or page that articulates how faculty embody the living curriculum, portrait-of-the-teacher ideals, and the ongoing professional development aligned with classical pedagogy.
- Develop a dedicated "Faculty as Living Curriculum" section with explicit examples of teacher exemplars, mentorship roles, and collaborative professional growth grounded in classical pedagogy (Socratic inquiry, rhetoric development, memory work).
- Create a standardized "Teacher Portraits" page that outlines what a classical-Christian teacher at Aletheia should be and do, including observable practices (model virtue, mentorship, classical pedagogy mastery), contributing to a transparent living curriculum narrative.
- Expand professional development aligned with classical pedagogy and publish annual or biennial reports detailing faculty development in Trivium pedagogy, memorization techniques, and Socratic/seminar facilitation.
- Augment parent formation with a structured program (book clubs, study guides, quarterly seminars) that explicitly links parent learning to classroom outcomes, reinforcing the co-teacher model.

Rationale: Implementing these items would elevate Element 5 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL by making the living curriculum and teacher-formation narrative explicit and verifiable across communications, thereby reinforcing the six-category alignment a classical school rubric expects.

Citations informing this section reflect prior observations about faculty descriptions and the absence of a fully codified "living curriculum" statement in public materials (Staff pages and testimonials) .

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1 — CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — CLASSICAL

Overall, the school earns CLASSICAL in aggregate.

Executive Summary — Final classification: CLASSICAL

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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